

STAGE THIRTEEN • TEAMWORK & COLLABORATION

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each session, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Thirteen • Teamwork & Collaboration

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below 2-3 days before each session. The most important piece of pre-work across this entire stage is having a real team project to reference — everything works better applied to something genuine than something hypothetical.

Before Session 1: Team Foundations

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Identify one current or upcoming team project you can reference throughout this entire stage. If you don't have one, that's fine — we'll form a temporary working team at the start of the session.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This session works dramatically better applied to something real. Arriving with a genuine project in mind, even a loosely defined one, makes every exercise more useful.

Before Session 2: Working Together in Practice

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring a real, current problem your team is facing, if one exists.
- If you work with people from different functions, cultural backgrounds, or remote locations, come ready to reflect on that real experience specifically.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several exercises this session are reflective and land far better grounded in genuine, lived experience than a hypothetical scenario.

Before Session 3: Navigating Difficulty & Closing Out

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- This session covers genuinely harder territory — conflict, difficult teammates, and honest retrospectives. Come ready for more honesty than the previous two sessions asked for.
- This is the final session of the stage; it closes by combining practices from across all three sessions, so come ready to look back, not just forward.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Knowing in advance that this session asks for real honesty helps participants arrive prepared rather than caught off guard by the shift in tone.